

Cat Morning Meowing Fix — Action Checklist

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AUDIT YOUR RESPONSE PATTERN

- ☐ **Audit Your Response Pattern:** Track your morning sequence for 3 consecutive days by recording when meowing starts, what you do first, how long you wait before responding, and what eventually stops it. This data determines exactly where your reinforcement cycle begins and where it ends.
- ☐ **Audit Your Response Pattern:** Identify your exact breaking point by honestly determining the maximum duration of meowing you can tolerate before responding. Write this threshold down because your cat has already learned it and times her behavior accordingly.
- ☐ **Audit Your Response Pattern:** Make a household agreement before starting so that everyone understands no one will respond to meowing during the protocol. If anyone breaks the zero response rule, the entire 14-day cycle resets and you have to start over from the beginning.
- ☐ **Audit Your Response Pattern:** Understand that all responses count as rewards including yelling, petting, eye contact, speaking the cat's name, turning on lights, and putting food in the bowl. Any of these actions tells your cat that meowing worked and she should do it again tomorrow.

RUN ZERO RESPONSE PROTOCOL

- ☐ **Run Zero Response Protocol:** Implement zero response for a full 14 days by providing no eye contact, no speaking, no getting up, no lights, no food, and no physical interaction whenever your cat meows during your normal wake window.
- ☐ **Run Zero Response Protocol:** Expect meowing to intensify during days 1-3 as the cat tests whether persistence still produces results and she will escalate the behavior to see if you crack first.
- ☐ **Run Zero Response Protocol:** Watch for new protest behaviors during days 8-11 such as pawing at you or knocking items off nightstands, which signals the cat is trying alternative strategies to get a response from you.
- ☐ **Run Zero Response Protocol:** Remain a "dead object" for the entire meowing window by staying present but irrelevant so your cat learns that her vocalizations produce no outcome whatsoever.

INSTALL AUTOMATIC FEEDER

- ☐ **Install Automatic Feeder:** Choose a feeder with programmable timing, jam-resistant reliability, and portion control that allows multiple small meals to extend the cat's food reward window and reduce post-meal hunting drive.
 - ☐ **Install Automatic Feeder:** Set the feeder to dispense food 30-60 minutes later than the cat's current wake-up time so she learns the machine produces food instead of her meowing getting you out of bed.
 - ☐ **Install Automatic Feeder:** After 2 weeks of consistent feeder operation, begin pushing the feeding time later by 15 minutes every 4-5 days until you reach your target wake time such as 7:00 AM.
 - ☐ **Install Automatic Feeder:** Keep feeder timing unchanged while the zero response period is running because adjusting both variables simultaneously prevents you from knowing which change actually worked to stop the meowing.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.